We Really Do Love Sosa — Edmundo Sosa's 2026, and maybe his Phillies run

Season recap · utility IF/OF, bats right · Philadelphia Phillies · 250 PA in 83 games · data through 2026-10-01

Prepared for: Front office (free-agency decision), player development, hitting coaches

2026: .247/.283/.429 · wOBA .307 · xwOBA .330 · BB 2.8% · K 21.6% · chase 52.8% · OOZ contact 57.6%

Governance: Use Case #56 (`uc-pos-021`) · build `dp_uc56` v1.0.0 · kernel `dp_uc56_kernel.py` imports `dp_uc55_kernel.py` (sha256 `9bdcce59…`) and `dp_uc46_kernel.py` (`a45ac9a7…`), 16 pins in all. New objects OZ-1 and WA-1 are provisional and were registered in the BID before computation. Independently verified; see `05_quality_certification.md`.

Companion: `dp_uc56_sosa_2026_dashboard.html`, the same story in 8 chapters.

Read this first: data window, sources, carry-ins.

- Regular season only for every rate. The client's frame also carried 19 spring and 7 Wild Card PA in 2026 (SRC-4) and his St. Louis years from a second file (SRC-5); both are graded in §8, never pooled.
- Baseline for 'prior Phillies years' = 2023-25 (836 PA). 2022 in Philadelphia was 59 PA: shown, never a baseline (SRC-6).
- House log through 2026-10-01; 2026 = 250 PA in 83 games, 138 vs LHP / 112 vs RHP. Reconciles to Baseball-Reference (CI-1: .247/.283/.429, 250 PA).
- Carry-ins (labelled CI-n) come from Baseball-Reference, NBC Sports Philadelphia, PhillyVoice, Spotrac, MLB.com, ESPN and the AP; they are quoted, never computed on. The walkaway band (§7) is arithmetic on carry-ins and says so.
- EV50 here is the median exit velocity (the client's definition, GL-1). Statcast's public EV50 is the mean of the hardest 50% of batted balls; the two are not interchangeable.

1 · Bottom line

1. **Yes, 2026 was a down year - in results.** .307 wOBA and .712 OPS were the worst of his four full Phillies seasons, and the cumulative line ran last at every 50-PA checkpoint.
2. **No, it wasn't a down year in the bat.** His .330 xwOBA was the best of his four full Phillies seasons, his EV90 (105.9 mph) a career high, and bat speed held (71.2 mph). Zero of six pre-registered decline flags tripped. BABIP .281 was his lowest.
3. **The late uptick was the results catching up, not a better hitter.** After the break, wOBA rose .272 → .371 while xwOBA fell .344 → .305 (TR-1: RESULTS TURN).
4. **The chase-and-contact approach is sustainable, and expensive in volume.** 52.8% chase was the highest of 42 Phillies RHB seasons since 2022, but his out-of-zone contact is above the median and his out-of-zone BA was earned (OZ-1). Each chase costs less than a typical righty's; he just chases more.
5. **He's a bench bat who mashes lefties, not an everyday player.** vs LHP .362 wOBA (2023-25), vs RHP .286, with a 2.8% walk rate. Five seasons, five positions, a .320 Phillies wOBA - 5th of 9 Phillies with 800+ PA.
6. **Walkaway: $6.0M a year, no more than 2 years.** Open near his 2026 salary ($4.4M, CI-3). If another club pays more or longer, it's paying for an everyday player - let him go.

2 · The 2026 line (Q1)

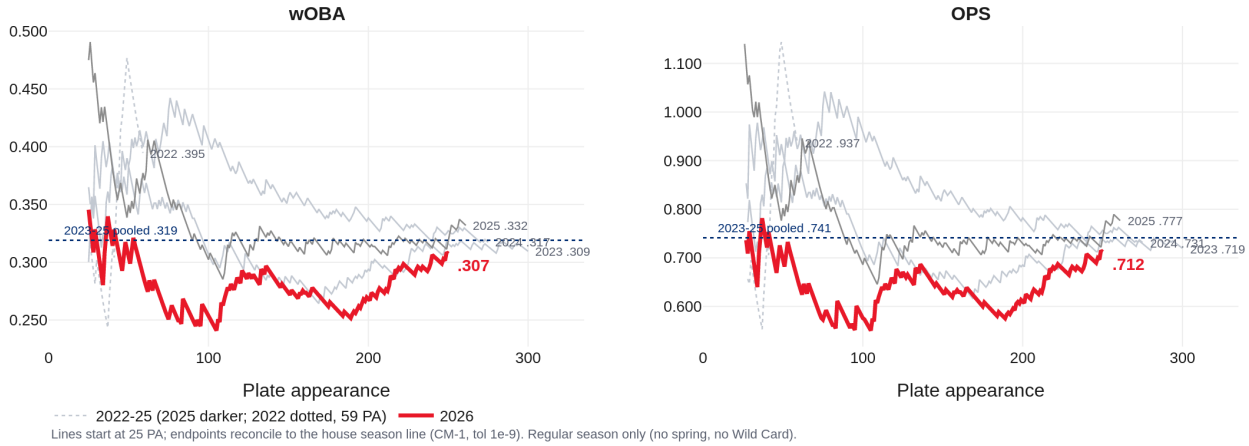
.247/.283/.429, .307 wOBA, .712 OPS. Against his own 2023-25 Phillies seasons, 2026 ranks 4th of four in wOBA, OBP and OPS - and 1st in xwOBA. The cumulative lines put it plainly: 2026 was last at 50, 100, 150, 200 and 250 PA, bottoming at .253 at 100 PA. The season card says why it isn't the whole story: his contact quality was the best it's been.

Season	PA	AVG/OBP/SLG	wOBA	xwOBA	BB%	K%	Swing	Chase	OOZ contact	Hard-hit	Barrel	EV90
2022	59	.315/.345/.593	.395	.334	1.7%	20.3%	57.8%	45.3%	50.0%	34.1%	9.1%	103.3
2023	300	.251/.293/.427	.309	.288	2.7%	24.7%	59.4%	43.1%	59.1%	32.2%	6.7%	104.8
2024	275	.256/.311/.420	.317	.311	4.7%	24.0%	56.8%	40.5%	49.6%	41.4%	8.6%	105.2
2025	261	.276/.307/.469	.332	.302	3.8%	21.5%	57.1%	45.5%	61.2%	38.0%	6.2%	104.1

Season	PA	AVG/OBP/SLG	wOBA	xwOBA	BB%	K%	Swing	Chase	OOZ contact	Hard-hit	Barrel	EV90
2026	250	.247/.283/.429	.307	.330	2.8%	21.6%	61.2%	52.8%	57.6%	39.2%	7.2%	105.9
STL 2021 (context, SRC-5)	324	.271/.342/.389	.322	.310				34.2%	54.8%			
STL 2022 (context, SRC-5)	131	.189/.244/.270	.232	.250				45.8%	48.1%			

2026 trailed every prior Phillies season, start to finish: .307 wOBA, .712 OPS

Cumulative by plate appearance, 2026 against his 2022-25 Phillies seasons. At every 50-PA checkpoint (50 to 250) 2026 ranked last of his four full Phillies seasons in both wOBA and OPS. The late climb (from .268 at 200 PA) only got it back to the bottom of the pack.

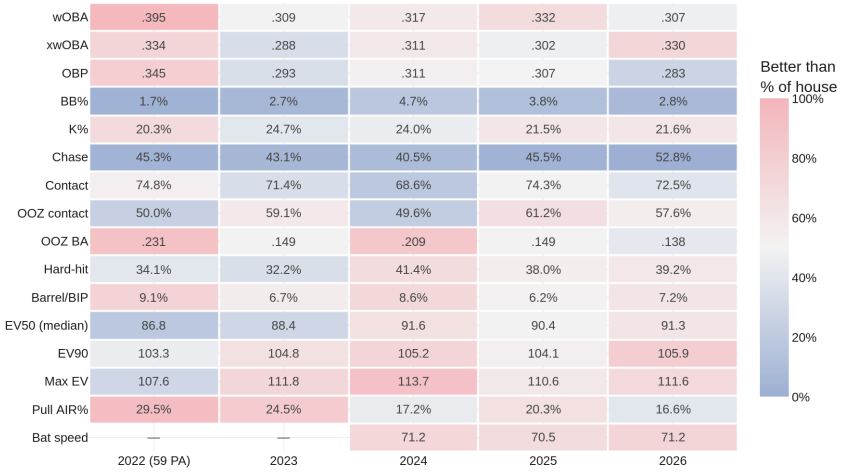


Lines start at 25 PA; endpoints reconcile to the house season line (CM-1, tol 1e-9). Regular season only (no spring, no Wild Card).

Receipts: out/dp_uc56_cum_woba.csv, out/dp_uc56_cum_ops.csv, out/dp_uc56_cum_checkpoints.csv · claim asserted before render

Results down, contact quality up: 2026 had his worst wOBA and his best xwOBA and EV90

Five Phillies seasons on the house KPI panel plus the client's batted-ball asks. Cell colour = share of 220 Phillies hitter-seasons (2015-2026, ≥50 PA) he beat; red = better, blue = worse (low K% and chase colour red). Of 2023-26, 2026 ranks 4th in wOBA, 1st in xwOBA and EV90, 4th (worst) in chase and pull-air. EV50 = median EV (client definition, GL-1). Bat speed ships from 2024.



Receipts: out/dp_uc56_season_card.csv · claim asserted before render

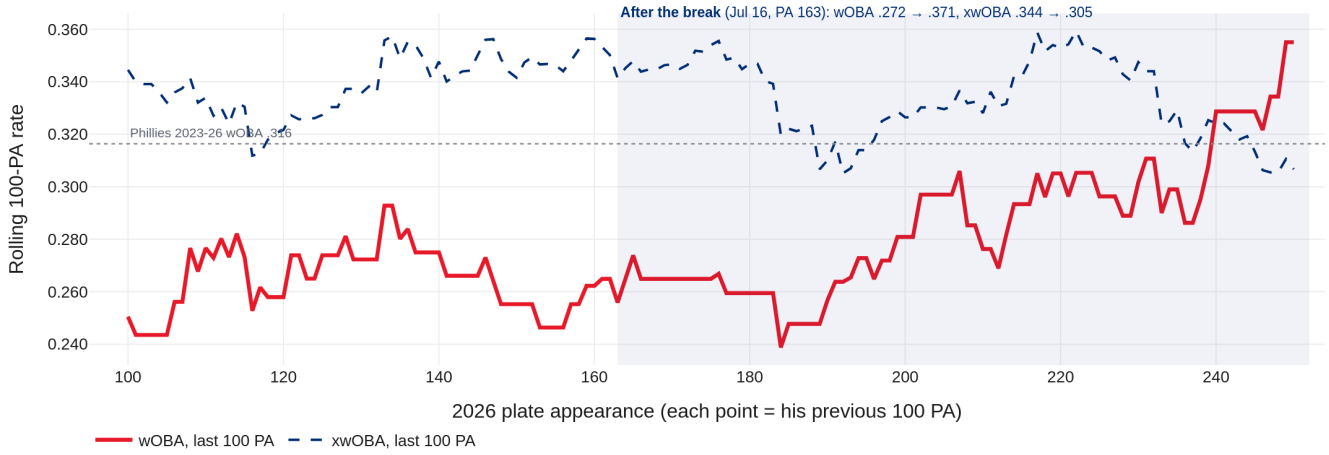
3 · Was there an uptick? (Q2)

Yes in the box score, no under it. The All-Star-break test was fixed in the BID before anything was computed: results improved on all four signatures (wOBA .272 → .371, SLG .367 → .536), process on none - xwOBA, strikeout rate, hard-hit rate and whiff rate all moved the wrong way. ER-1 finds no change point anywhere in 2023-26 (and at 250 PA it would detect a .080 step only 30% of the time). The media's 'final 50 games' frame (CI-2: .806 OPS in 149 PA) reproduces at .787 OPS over his last 50 games with a PA

(153 PA) - real, but chosen after the fact. Read it as a first half that ran unlucky (.272 wOBA on .344 xwOBA) and a second half that ran a little lucky.

The second-half uptick was the results catching up, not a better hitter

Rolling 100-PA wOBA (red) and xwOBA (navy) through 2026; shaded from the first game after the All-Star break (fixed in the BID before looking). TR-1 call: RESULTS TURN - results improved on all four signatures, process on none (xwOBA, K%, hard-hit and whiff moved the wrong way). ER-1 finds no change point in 2026 (at 250 PA it would catch a .080 step only 30% of the time). Lines start at his 100th PA (early June).



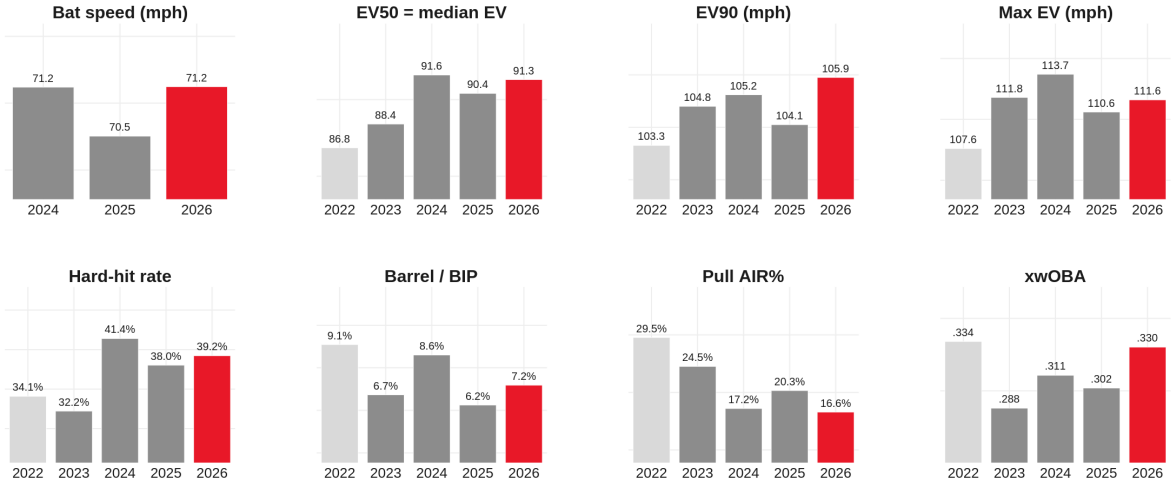
Receipts: out/dp_uc56_rolling_100pa.csv, out/dp_uc56_tr1_asb_ledger.csv, out/dp_uc56_er1_segments_woba.csv · claim asserted before render

4 · Batted ball: over the hump? (Q3)

Not by any measure of force. Against his 2023-25 mean: bat speed +0.4 mph (5th of 16 tracked Phillies hitters), EV90 +1.2 mph, hard-hit +2.0 points, barrel rate flat, xwOBA +0.030. Max EV 111.6 mph and median EV 91.3 mph sit with his 2024-25 levels. What did slide is shape: pull-air 16.6% (his lowest; 20.3% in 2025, 24.5% in 2023) and ground balls 46.4% (his highest). Hard contact on the ground is how a .330 xwOBA becomes a .307 wOBA.

Over the hump? Not by the batted ball: 0 of 6 pre-registered decline flags tripped

Season values, 2026 in red (2022 = 59 PA, pale). Against his 2023-25 Phillies mean, 2026 bat speed +0.4 mph, EV90 +1.2 mph, hard-hit +2.0 pts, barrel flat, xwOBA +0.030. The one slide is shape, not force: pull-air 16.6% (his lowest) with ground balls at 46.4% (his highest).



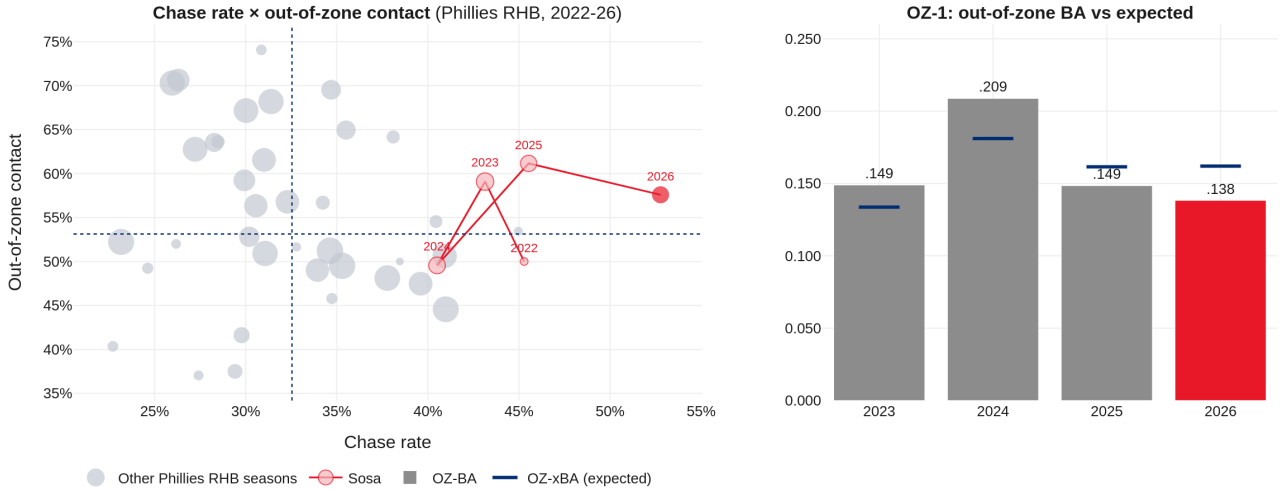
Receipts: out/dp_uc56_season_panel.csv, out/dp_uc56_wa1_decline_flags.csv · claim asserted before render

5 · The approach: chase, contact, swing (Q4, Q6)

He is exactly who you said: a swinger. 61.2% swing rate (97th percentile of Phillies RHB seasons) and 52.8% chase, the highest in the pool. The 'high contact' half is narrower: overall contact 72.5% is below the RHB median, but out-of-zone contact 57.6% is above it (53.1%). Is it sustainable? OZ-1 says his out-of-zone BA (.138) ran 24 points under expected (.162) - earned, not lucky - in three of four seasons. CC-1 prices it: 8.7 runs lost per 100 chases (RHB median 11.3), but 4.6 per 100 out-of-zone pitches seen (median 3.7). The individual chase is cheap; the volume isn't. On your scatter, swing rate barely tracks wOBA across Phillies righties (r = 0.14).

The most aggressive chaser on the roster, and the out-of-zone contact is real

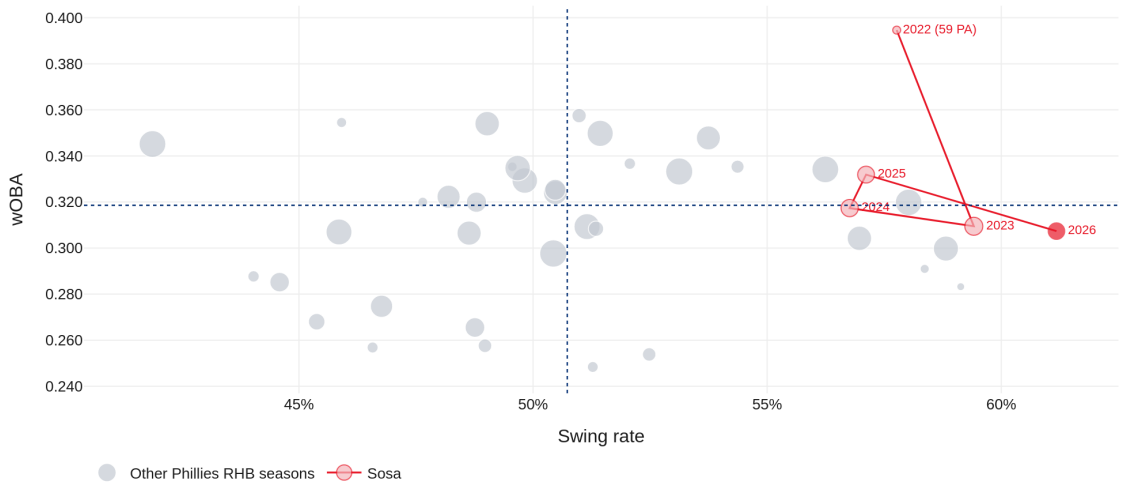
Left: 42 Phillies RHB seasons (≥50 PA), dot size = PA; navy lines = medians. His 52.8% chase in 2026 is the highest in the pool; his out-of-zone contact (57.6%) sits above the median. Right: BA on PAs ending out of the zone vs the expected BA on the same at-bats (OZ-1). 2026 ran 24 points under expected - not luck carrying him. Each chase cost 8.7 runs per 100 (RHB median 11.3); the bill is volume.



Receipts: out/dp_uc56_rhb_pool_2022_26.csv, out/dp_uc56_season_panel.csv, out/dp_uc56_cc1_chase_cost.csv · claim asserted before render

Always a swinger; above the RHB wOBA median only in 2025 (and 2022's 59 PA)

Your scatter, rebuilt on the house pool: 42 Phillies RHB seasons 2022-26 with ≥50 PA, regular season only, dot size = PA, navy = medians. Sosa's swing rate sat in the top quartile every season (97th percentile in 2026). Across the pool, swing rate barely tracks wOBA (r = 0.14; 0.07 PA-weighted).



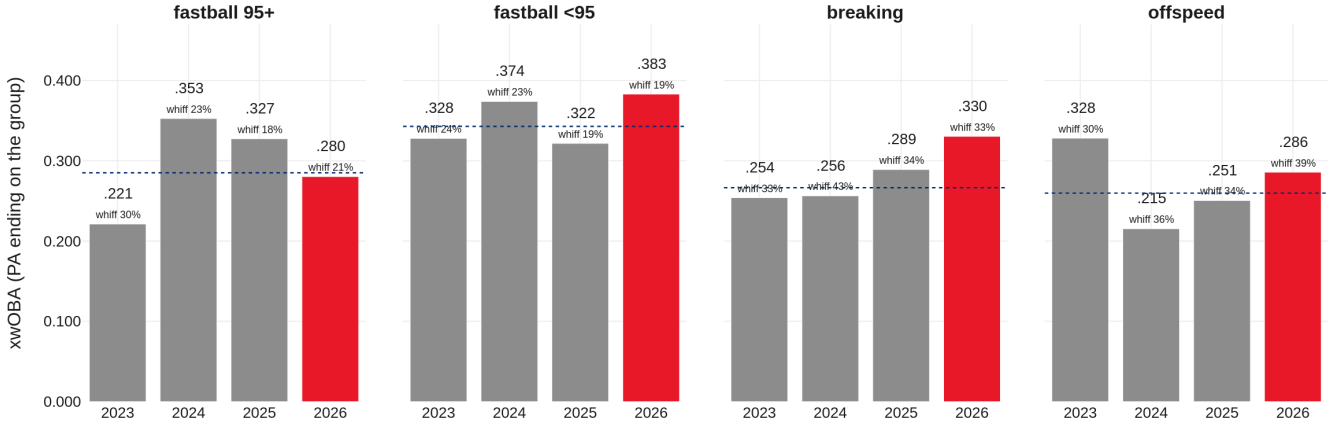
Receipts: out/dp_uc56_rhb_pool_2022_26.csv · claim asserted before render

6 · Velocity and breaking balls (Q5)

No fall-off against velocity in the process: on 95+ fastballs his whiff rate fell (23.6% → 20.8%) and xwOBA matched his pooled 2023-25 line (.285 → .280). The results fell (.291 → .220 wOBA on 43 PA), and xwOBA sits below his 2024-25 peaks - a watch item. Breaking balls were never his strength (.268 wOBA 2023-25) and 2026 was his best expected year against them (.330 xwOBA). If there's a 2026 hole it's swing-and-miss on offspeed: 39.0% whiff, 66.3% chase.

Velocity and breaking balls held; offspeed is where he swings and misses

xwOBA on PAs ending on each pitch group, with whiff rate per swing under each bar; navy dotted = his 2023-25 pooled xwOBA. Against 95+ fastballs his whiff fell (23.6% → 20.8%) and xwOBA matched the pooled line (.285 → .280), though below 2024-25 - a watch item, not a fall-off. Breaking balls were never a strength (.268 wOBA 2023-25) and 2026 was his best expected year against them. Offspeed: whiff 39.0% and chase 66.3%, both his worst - though the contact he made was fine. Samples are 28-83 PA per bar.



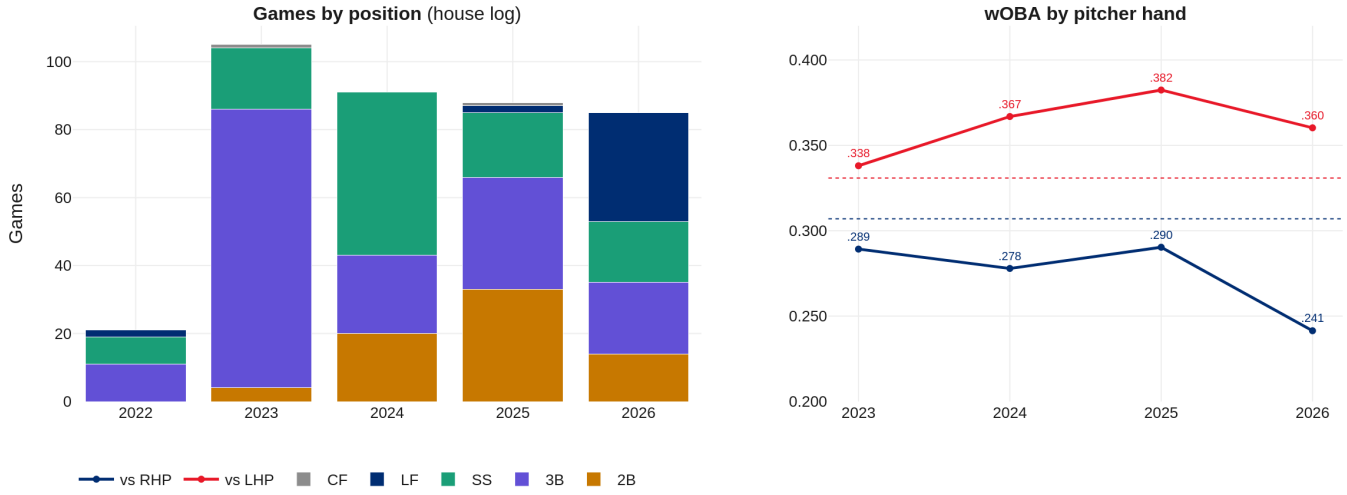
Receipts: out/dp_uc56_pitch_group_by_season.csv, out/dp_uc56_pitch_group_baseline_2023_25.csv · claim asserted before render

7 · Five seasons in red pinstripes (Q7)

Phillies 2022-26: 1145 PA in 365 games, .260/.301/.444, 39 HR, 106 extra-base hits, .320 wOBA - 5th of the 9 Phillies with 800+ PA in that span and 2nd of 5 right-handed hitters (PhillyVoice, CI-7: .260/.302/.444). Carry-in bWAR 0.8 / 0.6 / 2.2 / 2.3 / 1.0 (CI-4). He played 4 positions in 2026, adding left field (32 games, CI-4). The profile is a platoon bat: .360 wOBA vs LHP in 2026 against . 241 vs RHP; all Phillies righties were .331 / .307. That is the answer to 'over the hump or still valuable': still valuable, in the role he's had.

Five seasons, five positions, one job: hit left-handers

Phillies 2022-26: 1145 PA, .260/.301/.444, 39 HR, wOBA .320 - 5th of 9 Phillies with ≥800 PA. Left: games at each position (a late move counts both; B-Ref carry-in beside it in the report). Right: vs LHP .362 in 2023-25, vs RHP .286; dotted = all Phillies RHB 2022-26 by hand.



Receipts: out/dp_uc56_games_by_position.csv, out/dp_uc56_platoon_by_season.csv, out/dp_uc56_phi_2022_26_tenure_board.csv · claim asserted before render

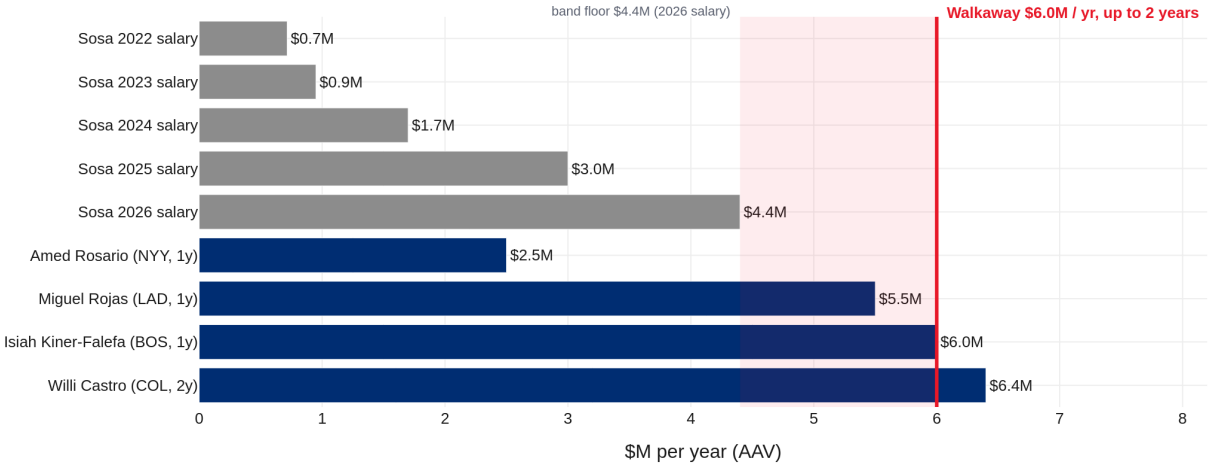
8 · The walkaway number (Q8)

WA-1 was written into the BID before any decline flag was computed. Band: his 2026 salary ($4.4M, CI-3) to the top AAV among 2025-26 utility deals ($6.4M, Willi Castro 2/$12.8M; Kiner-Falefa 1/$6.0M, Rojas 1/$5.5M, Rosario 1/$2.5M - CI-5). Ceiling rounded down to $6.0M. Term: 0 of 6 decline flags tripped, so up to 2 years. **Walkaway: $6.0M AAV, 2 years, $12M total.** A sensible opening is one year near his 2026 salary with a club option. If a team offers him everyday money (more per year, or a third year), the data in this report says that team is buying everyday at-bats against righties, where he has a .286 wOBA (2023-25) - let it go. Context the rule doesn't price: the CBA expires after 2026 (CI-2), he turns 31 in March (CI-6), and he left the Wild Card series with a groin injury (CI-6).

Flag	Metric	2023-25 baseline	2026	Change	Bar	Tripped?
DF-1	Bat speed (mph)	70.9	71.2	+0.4	1.0	no
DF-2	EV90 (mph)	104.7	105.9	+1.2	1.0	no
DF-3	Hard-hit rate	37.2%	39.2%	+2.0 pts	0.04	no
DF-4	Barrel / BIP	7.2%	7.2%	flat	0.02	no
DF-5	xwOBA	.300	.330	+0.030	0.02	no
DF-6	Out-of-zone contact	56.6%	57.6%	+1.0 pts	0.03	no

The walkaway: $6.0M a year, no more than 2 years

Gray: his arbitration salaries 2022-26 (carry-in CI-3). Navy: 2025-26 offseason utility deals, AAV (CI-5). Shaded: the WA-1 band from his 2026 salary to the top comp ($6.4M, rounded down to $0.5M). Term: 0 of 6 decline flags tripped, so up to 2 years. An offer above this line is everyday-player money; let it go. Carry-in arithmetic, not a valuation model.



Receipts: out/dp_uc56_wa1_comps.csv, out/dp_uc56_wa1_decline_flags.csv · claim asserted before render

9 · Your notebook, graded

Each claim is reproduced first on your own frame (`nphl` + `pos`, no game-type filter, your functions), then graded on the governed build.

#	Claim	Your frame	Governed	Grade
HP-01	2026 top-line 'should be below his results from prior years with the Phillies'	wOBA 2026 .300 vs 2025 .345 (client frame, incl. spring + WC)	wOBA .307 (4th of 2023-26), OPS .712, OBP .283; but xwOBA .330 is his best Phillies season	**SUPPORTED (results)**
HP-02	Cumulative wOBA/OPS 'highlighting 2026 as a down year overall'	client frame: n/a (the notebook drew no cumulative chart)	2026 last of 2023-26 at 100% of 50-PA checkpoints (wOBA and OPS, 50-250 PA)	**SUPPORTED**
HP-03	'An uptick in performance throughout the year'	client frame: n/a	TR-1 at the break (2026-07-16): wOBA .272 -> .371, xwOBA .344 -> .305; call RESULTS TURN; ER-1: no 2026 change point	**RESULTS ONLY**
HP-04	'A high-chase and high-contact guy'	chase 53.3%, contact 73.0%, OOZ contact 57.8% (client frame)	chase 52.8% = highest of 42 Phillies RHB seasons 2022-26; contact 72.5% (40th pct); OOZ contact 57.6% (61th pct)	**PARTLY**
HP-05	OOZ contact and OOZ BA - 'are those sustainable?'	OOZ BA .146 (client frame)	OZ-1 2026: OZ-BA .138 vs OZ-xBA .162 -> EARNED; OOZ contact above RHB median (53.1%); CC-1 8.7 runs per 100 chases vs RHB median 11.3	**SUSTAINABLE**
HP-06	'Has he fallen off against velocity'	client frame: not computed in this notebook	95+ fastballs 2026: wOBA .220 vs .291 (2023-25); xwOBA .280 vs .285; whiff 20.8% vs 23.6% (p=0.54)	**NOT SUPPORTED (process)**
HP-07	'Previously strong against breaking balls but not so much now'	client frame: not computed in this notebook	breaking 2023-25: wOBA .268, whiff 36.4%; 2026: xwOBA .330, whiff 32.5%	**CONTRADICTED**
HP-08	'Edmundo swung the bat and had high wOBAs among Phillies RHB'	client scatter: 80 RHB-seasons (no PA floor, every game type)	swing-rate pct by season: 2022 83, 2023 95, 2024 76, 2025 80, 2026 97; wOBA pct: 2022 97, 2023 45, 2024 47, 2025 66, 2026 38 (n=42)	**PARTLY**
HP-09	'The Phillies put a premium on right handed hitters who swing the bat'	client scatter r = nan (all rows); 0.05 at >=50 PA	house pool (RHB 2022-26, >=50 PA, n=42): r = 0.14; PA-weighted 0.07	**NOT VISIBLE IN OUTCOMES**
HP-10		client frame: n/a	Phillies 2022-26: 1145 PA, .260/.301/.444, wOBA .320 = 5 of 9 Phillies with >=800 PA (2 of 5 RHB)	**SUPPORTED**

#	Claim	Your frame	Governed	Grade
	'Reliable bench player going back to 2022 ... a true positive force'			
HP-11	'The Phillies should not pay him like an everyday player'	client frame: n/a	vs RHP wOBA .286 (2023-25), .241 (2026) vs RHB pool .307; BB% 2.8% (7th pct); WA-1 walkaway $6.0M AAV, up to 2 years (DF 0/6)	**SUPPORTED**

Two notes on the code: your `inds ev_mu` averages `launch_speed` over every tracked pitch, fouls included, so it reads 5.8 mph below a balls-in-play mean (CL-2); and `pull_air_rate` is commented out in the notebook because cell 56 cannot run (O-7) - this build uses the patched v1.1.0 function from `uc-pos-017`.

Candid caveats

- Samples: 250 PA in 2026; pitch-group bars are 43-83 PA. Season-to-season moves under ~.030 wOBA are noise at this size.
- OZ-1, WA-1 are provisional (new this UC). WA-1 is carry-in arithmetic plus a data check on decline; it is not a valuation model and not financial advice.
- Bench usage shapes the numbers: he faced left-handers in 55% of 2026 PA. Any everyday projection must reweight to a normal platoon mix.
- Fielding: no OAA/DRS in the log. NBC's 'top 16% OAA and sprint speed' (CI-2) is quoted, not tested. Games by position count late moves twice.
- TR-1 compares two halves of one bench season (162 vs 88 PA); the call is about direction, not size.

Three things for 2027

1. **If he's back:** keep him in the lefty-heavy bench role; it is where all of his value lives.
2. **Ask the hitting staff about ground balls.** The force is intact; the pulled air balls aren't. That's the cheapest lever on a .330 xwOBA bat.
3. **Offspeed chase is the one approach item worth a conversation** - not velocity, not breaking balls.

Data through 2026-10-01 · uc-pos-021 · dp_uc56 v1.0.0 · sources: Statcast house log; carry-ins CI-1…CI-7 listed in the BID.